

For an SMB, a printer with an internal memory of 32MB to 128MB of RAM is a good option. However, there are high-end machines available with 256MB to 512MB of RAM. The graphics-oriented printers might possess an internal memory of about 1GB onwards. However, this is not a feature that you will find frequently in printers, especially not in the low-end models.

3. **Monthly duty cycle:** This is a number that denotes how many pages a printer can print in a month, without failing. Typically, the low-end business printers offer a monthly duty cycle that is in the range of 20,000 pages per month, which is good for an average SMB. However, there are high-end printers available that offer a range of 100,000 pages per month, as well.
4. **Paper handling:** When buying a printer, do ensure that the number of pages you need to print in a day is within the capacity of your printer. Typically, a printer that can hold 250 sheets of paper is good for an SMB set-up. However, there are high-end models available that can accommodate anywhere between 500 to 1000 pages in their standard configuration. Also, if you need to print on multiple sizes of paper, like envelopes, A3, et al, do ensure that the printer

you have chosen can accommodate such upgrades. Also check if the model can handle duplexing, in case you need to print on both sides of the paper.

5. **Operating system compatibility:** A lot of SMBs are now introducing Linux-based systems, with the objective of cutting down on their IT budgets. So, while buying a printer, the IT head should look at what kind of operating system support the device offers. Apart from Windows, one should check if the printer supports less-common platforms like Mac and Linux. Also, if you have users with multiple platforms under one roof, make sure that the printer has the required drivers to support all of them. Don't miss out on checking the functionality differences too.
6. **USB port:** Printers with USB ports were less popular a few years back, but with changing times, this is an important feature to look out for. The port lets users insert a USB drive and print directly from there. Although a USB port is a pretty handy feature, security is one aspect that cannot be ignored in this case. Users can unknowingly mess with the security of the device or the office network through this port. So be clear about who is to be allowed to use the USB port for printing.

Some of the best printers SMBs can select from



Price: ₹ 3,550

Ricoh Aficio SP 200

- High productivity
- 1200×600 dpi print resolution
- Less than 25-second warm up time
- Up to 22 ppm (A4)
- Less than 20,000 pages/month duty cycle

Samsung ML-2161/XIP single function laser printer

- Mono laser printer
- Supports one-touch screen print
- Up to 20 ppm in A4
- Up to 1200×1200 dpi effective output
- 150-sheet standard tray
- 100-sheet face down
- Two LEDs (toner, status)
- High-speed USB 2.0



Price: ₹ 3,786